Manuscript (Results section): Marking Rubric (individual)

Foundations of Clinical Research · Level 1: From Clinical Question to Publication

Organisation: Neudata (*#ClearDataClearImpact*)

Total: 100 points: the Results section 80 + peer review and response 20

Use with: `Manuscript_Brief.pdf`, `Peer_Review_Instructions.pdf` and the results pack for the participant's question (Q1 to Q5)

> Mark the **revised** Results section (due Saturday 9 January 2027). If no revision arrives, mark the draft and give 0 for criterion 9. Mark the writing, not the analysis.

How to score

1. Open the results pack next to the manuscript and check the numbers.
2. For each criterion, choose the level that fits best. Between two levels, choose the lower one.
3. Write one comment for each criterion that loses points: what to change and where.

Levels: Excellent: complete and correct. **Good**: minor gaps. **Needs work**: vague, incomplete or partly wrong. **Missing**: absent or wholly wrong.

A. The Results section (80 points)

Criterion	Excellent	Good	Needs work	Missing
1. Working title (5)	Names population, exposure, outcome and design. "Associated", no "impact". **5**	One element missing. **3**	Vague or causal wording. **1**	Absent. **0**
2. Participants (10) (STROBE 13)	Numbers enrolled, analysed and excluded at each step, with reasons. Survivors only for Q5. **10**	One step or reason missing. **7**	Only the total n. **3**	Absent. **0**
3. Descriptive data (10) (STROBE 14)	One or two sentences on how the groups differed at baseline, with numbers. Missing data reported. **10**	Correct but missing data not mentioned. **7**	Repeats Table 1 row by row, or uses p-values. **3**	Absent. **0**
4. Main results (20) (STROBE 15, 16)	Outcome numbers per group with denominators. Crude and adjusted estimates with 95% CI and the variables adjusted for. **20**	One element missing (e.g. crude estimate). **14**	p-values without effect sizes, or several numbers wrong. **6**	Absent. **0**
5. Other analyses (10) (STROBE 17)	The sensitivity, imputation or subgroup results in the pack, reported correctly (Q4: both complete-case and imputed). **10**	Reported with one error. **7**	Mentioned without numbers. **3**	Absent. **0**
6. Tables and figure (15)	Table 1 and one main table or figure that stand alone: title, units, n per column, abbreviations, sensible decimals. The figure suits the data. **15**	Minor formatting gaps. **10**	Cannot be read without the text, or wrong figure type. **5**	None. **0**
7. Reporting quality (10)	No interpretation. Calibrated words. Numbers in text and tables agree with the pack. Template used. AI-use statement present. **10**	One lapse. **7**	Interpretation or causal words in the Results, or no AI-use statement. **3**	Not applicable. **0**

Results subtotal: _____ / 80

B. Peer review and response (20 points)

Criterion	Excellent	Good	Needs work	Missing
8. Review given (10)	Specific and constructive, uses the checklist, checks the numbers against the pack, page or line for each comment. **10**	Good but some comments vague. **7**	Generic or rude. **3**	No review. **0**
9. Response and revision (10)	Every comment answered point by point (comment, reply, change and where). Disagreements explained. The changes are in the revised text. **10**	One comment unanswered or "done" without detail. **7**	Defensive, or changes claimed but not made. **3**	No response. **0**

Total: _____ / 100

C. Optional sections (feedback only, no points)

If the participant sent Methods, Introduction, Discussion or Abstract, write two or three comments on each:

- **Methods:** design, participants, variables, statistics and missing data match the results pack and the SAP.
- **Introduction:** known, not known, aim. The aim matches the analysis.
- **Discussion:** the six moves, limitations with their direction, conclusion no stronger than the design.
- **Abstract:** structured, 250 words or fewer, numbers identical to the Results.

Common problems

- Only the adjusted OR, or only the crude OR.
- "Positive fluid balance increased mortality": causal words from a cohort.
- p-values without effect sizes, "p = 0.000", percentages without denominators.
- Missing data not mentioned (especially lactate), or Q4 without both estimates.
- Mean (SD) for a skewed outcome (Q3, Q5).
- Hazard ratio read as a risk ratio (Q1).
- AI-use statement missing.